

WELL-TRAVELED EAGLE FLIES TO FREEDOM FOR THE THIRD TIME



Times photo by ROB LAYMAN

Carolina, a female bald eagle, soars to freedom Friday at Twentymile River near Portage. At 6 weeks, she was removed from a nest in Juneau in July of 1988. She was taken to Jefferson, Mo., and released in August of 1988. The eagle made her way to North Carolina, where researchers with the Caro-

lina Raptor Center found her struggling to survive in the heat. She was rehabilitated and released, but once again she had trouble. In August of 1990, the eagle came to the Bird Treatment and Learning Center in Anchorage where she was nursed back to health by Dr. Jim Scott and Debbi Johnson.

Alaska onshore processors gain pollock harvest

By DANIEL R. SADDLER

TIMES WRITER

Federal fisheries managers voted Friday to take most of the billion-dollar Alaska pollock harvest away from Seattle-based floating processors and give it to ships delivering to land-based processing plants.

The North Pacific Fishery Management Council voted 9-2 to reverse the trawler fleet's recent dominance of the fishery and guarantee shore-based plants the same share of the catch they had in 1987.

The vote is a major reallocation of the \$1 billion groundfishery. If ratified by the U.S. secretary of commerce, it would take effect at the start of the 1992 pollock season.

"It's going to provide an opportunity for coastal Alaska to develop real economic and social stability," said council member Larry Cotter of Juneau.

"From the Alaskan perspective, it means that communities on the Aleutian chain, the Gulf of Alaska and western Alaska are finally in a position to reap the benefits of the Magnuson Act," he said.

Supporters of the plan, mostly those in the onshore processing industry and the small boats that sell them fish, said it ensures their survival while the council decides how to solve the problem of too many boats chasing the fish.

"It's a step in the right direc-

See Pollock, page A13

Senate OKs 5-day wait on handguns

ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Senate voted 67-32 on Friday to require background checks of handgun purchasers within five working days as it cemented a toughened version of the House-passed "Brady Bill" into a broad anti-crime package.

The Senate's variation of the historic gun-control measure stiffens the bill, which cleared the House last month, by making

police checks mandatory during the waiting period for delivery of handguns to would-be purchasers.

The House bill required a seven-day waiting period, but left the checks for criminal or mental records to the discretion of police.

The five-working-days proposal was offered by Republican Leader Robert Dole, R-Kan.,

See Crime, page A13